ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 8 · SET 05

Max. Marks: 60 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct points / examples to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) The 'paradox of plenty' is another name for the —

(A) Doctrine of Lapse (B) natural resource curse
(C) demographic dividend (D) token currency

> **Ans: (B)** Resource-rich regions may grow slowly if they fail to build industries that add value.

(ii) India's unique high-quality steel, famous across the world, which combined local resources with human skill, was called —

(A) Damascus brass (B) Wootz steel (C) Bessemer steel (D) Cast iron

> **Ans: (B)** Wootz is an example of how location of resources and human skill create unique products.

(iii) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option.

1. Death of Aurangzeb
2. Battle of Saraighat
3. Battle of Haldighati
4. First Battle of Panipat

(A) 3, 4, 2, 1 (B) 4, 2, 3, 1 (C) 4, 3, 1, 2 (D) 4, 3, 2, 1

> **Ans: (D)** Correct order: First Battle of Panipat (1526) → Battle of Haldighati (1576) → Battle of Saraighat (1671) → Death of Aurangzeb (1707)

(iv) Which ruler of the Eastern Ganga kingdom repelled several Sultanate inroads and built the Surya temple at Konark partly to mark his victories?

(A) Narasimhadeva I (B) Krishnadevaraya (C) Rana Kumbha (D) Harihara

> **Ans: (A)** He ruled Kalinga in the mid-13th century.

(v) The 'hundi' of medieval India was —

(A) a tax on non-Muslims
(B) a land grant to officers
(C) a written order to make payment to a person, usable across political borders
(D) a copper coin of Muhammad bin Tughlaq

> **Ans: (C)** It was a precursor of modern banking; Marwaris used it widely.

(vi) The Adnyapatra (1715), which declares 'Forts are the core of the state', was written by —

(A) Shahji (B) Kanhoji Angre
(C) Mahadji Shinde (D) Ramachandrapant Amatya

> **Ans: (D)** He was Shivaji's finance minister.

(vii) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option.
Statement I: Shivaji sacked the Mughal port of Surat twice.
Statement II: Ahilyabai Holkar ruled from Pune and rebuilt the Kashi Vishwanath temple.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

> **Ans: (A)** Ahilyabai ruled around Indore (Holkar dynasty).

(viii) Under the Subsidiary Alliance, an Indian ruler had to —

(A) pay chauth and sardeshmukhi to the Marathas

(B) hand over his capital to the Company

(C) maintain British troops at his own expense and conduct foreign relations through the British

(D) give up his army to the Nawab of Bengal

> **Ans: (C)** A British Resident was placed at the court — real power passed to the British ('empire on the cheap').

(ix) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option.

Assertion (A): The railways built under British rule were not primarily meant to benefit Indians.

Reason (R): They were designed to carry raw materials to ports and British goods to the interior, and were largely paid for out of Indian taxes.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect

(B) A is incorrect, R is correct

(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A

(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

> **Ans: (C)** R gives the reasons for A.

(x) After the annexation of her kingdom, Begum Hazrat Mahal of Awadh finally took refuge in —

(A) Bhutan (B) Nepal (C) Burma (D) Afghanistan

> **Ans: (B)** She had led the defence of Lucknow and rejected British offers of safe passage.

(xi) In a First-Past-the-Post election, 100 votes are shared by four candidates as 34, 30, 20 and 16. Who wins?

(A) The candidate with 34 votes (B) The candidate with 30 votes

(C) No one, since nobody has 50 votes (D) The candidate with 16 votes

> **Ans: (A)** The highest vote-getter wins, even without a majority.

(xii) The Vice President of India is elected by —

(A) an electoral college of members of both Houses of Parliament

(B) the people directly

(C) the MLAs only

(D) the Lok Sabha only

> **Ans: (A)** Elected and nominated members of both Houses take part, by single transferable vote.

(xiii) The 86th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002 (Article 21A) paved the way for the —

(A) Right to Information Act

(B) Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009

(C) Money Bill of 1956

(D) Model Code of Conduct

> **Ans: (B)** The RTE Act has roots in the Directive Principles.

(xiv) If a Union law and a State law conflict on a subject in the Concurrent List, which one prevails?

(A) The State law (B) Whichever was made earlier

(C) The Union law (D) The one the Governor chooses

> **Ans: (C)** On the Concurrent List both can legislate, but the Union law prevails.

(xv) A 'supply chain' means —

(A) a chain of retail shops owned by one person

(B) a bank loan paid in instalments

(C) a government list of exports

(D) the network of individuals, organisations, resources, activities and technology involved in production and sale

> **Ans: (D)** COVID-19 showed how a break in the chain can halt production.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) What was wootz steel? Why is it an example of resources combined with skill?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - A unique high-quality steel of India, traded worldwide — 1 mark
> - It came from the location of resources (ore) combined with human skill of Indian craftspeople — 1 mark

O R

2.(B) How has India largely avoided the 'natural resource curse'?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - By investing in industries that process its resources into higher-value products — 1 mark
> - Through human knowledge, good governance and strategic planning — 1 mark

3. What was the hundi system? Why was it important?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - A written instruction to make a payment to a person, carried across political borders — 1 mark
> - It was a precursor of modern banking and helped trade across regimes — 1 mark

4. State any two differences between the Legislature and the Executive.

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - Legislature makes laws and oversees the Executive; Executive enforces/implements the laws
> - Legislature = President + Lok Sabha + Rajya Sabha; Executive = President, Vice President and the Council of Ministers
> - Legislature sanctions expenses; Executive prepares and implements the budget (any two, 1 mark each)

5.(A) What two aims did Timur state for his invasion of India? What was its result?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Aims: war with the 'infidels' and plunder of their wealth — 1 mark
> - Result: Delhi devastated, many killed or enslaved; chaos followed, leaving the Sultanate weakened — 1 mark

O R

5.(B) Why is Rana Sanga remembered? By whom was he defeated?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - He unified several Rajput clans and won many battles against sultans — 1 mark
> - Defeated by Babur at the Battle of Khanwa — 1 mark

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Describe any three features of the resistance offered to the Delhi Sultanate by the Eastern Gangas and the Musunuri Nayakas.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Eastern Ganga kingdom of Kalinga (Odisha) under Narasimhadeva I repelled several Sultanate inroads
- He built the Surya temple at Konark partly to commemorate his victories
- Musunuri Nayakas rallied over 75 chieftains into a confederacy
- They expelled Muhammad bin Tughlaq's army from Warangal (c. 1330–36)

O R

6.(B) Describe any three features of the economy of India during the Sultanate and Mughal periods.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Agriculture was the mainstay; land revenue about one-fifth of produce; Persian wheel expanded irrigation
- Food and non-food crops — rice, wheat, sugarcane; cotton, silk, jute
- Thriving crafts and shipbuilding; exports through ports such as Calicut, Surat, Masulipatnam
- Mughal silver rupaya and copper dam; guilds (shrenis) and temple-based credit; hundis

7.(A) Explain any three ways in which the Marathas revived Indian culture and language.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Shivaji's seal had a Sanskrit inscription instead of the prevalent Persian
- The Rajya-Vyavahara-Kosha gave Sanskrit equivalents for Persian words in diplomacy
- Rebuilt desecrated temples; promoted Sanskrit and Marathi literature and traditional arts
- Modi script used for correspondence; Jagannath worship at Puri revived with Bhonsle support

O R

7.(B) Describe any three contributions of Tarabai to the Maratha cause.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- A fearless warrior queen who ruled in the early 18th century after the death of her husband Rajaram
- Realised that north India was unprotected while Aurangzeb was in the Deccan
- Organised large Maratha armies and sent them to invade Mughal territories
- Architect of the northward expansion; preserved Maratha independence in a critical period

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Explain the 'drain of wealth' from India during British rule. Mention any five points.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- After Plassey the Company collected revenue from Bengal, Bihar and Odisha and invested little in them
- Brooks Adams: the Bengal plunder reached London soon after Plassey and helped Britain's Industrial Revolution
- Dadabhai Naoroji's 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India' (1901) compiled the drain from British reports
- R.C. Dutt's 'Economic History of India' also documented it
- Indians paid for railways, telegraph, and even wars of the colonial power
- Utsa Patnaik's estimate: about 45 trillion US dollars drained (1765–1938)

O R

8.(B) Evaluate the legacy of European colonialism in India in five points.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Not a 'civilising mission' — India's civilisation was far older; the process was systematic exploitation
- Wealth drain, deindustrialisation, famines; India's share of world GDP fell to about 5%
- Thousands of statues, jewels and manuscripts taken to European museums
- Unintended effects: surveys, documentation of monuments, archaeology
- First European translations of Sanskrit texts (Charles Wilkins, Bhagavad Gita, 1785) influenced European thinkers
- Political domination flowed one way, but cultural influence sometimes flowed the other

9. Explain the responsibilities of a business towards the environment and its workers. Mention any five points.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Reduce waste and avoid pollution (e.g. leather factories polluting rivers)
- Recycle and replenish resources; manage e-waste safely
- Fair compensation and safe working conditions for workers
- Skill development, workplace rights, benefits, no discrimination
- Corporate Social Responsibility — in 2014 India mandated 2% of average profits for CSR

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Vrikshayurveda is an ancient Indian science on the care of plants and trees. The word joins 'vriksha' (tree) with 'ayurveda' (science of life). Texts such as Surapala's Vrikshayurveda (around the 10th century CE) advise which plants suit which soils, how to collect and store seeds, how much to irrigate in each season, and how to use natural pest repellents. They also recommend crop rotation and mixed cropping, and ploughing that keeps soil moist and protects fungi, bacteria and earthworms.

(10.1) Which two Sanskrit words join to form 'Vrikshayurveda'?

Vriksha (tree) and ayurveda (science of life/health).

(10.2) Name one natural method mentioned in the passage for protecting crops from pests.

Natural pest repellents (also acceptable: crop rotation or mixed cropping).

(10.3) How is such traditional knowledge useful today? Give two points.

Any two (1 mark each): reduces dependence on chemical fertilisers/pesticides; protects soil life and moisture; supports sustainable/organic farming (e.g. Sikkim); lowers farmers' costs and debt.

11. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Babur, a descendant of Timur, was driven out of Samarkand and turned to India. In 1526, he defeated Ibrahim Lodi at the First Battle of Panipat using gunpowder, field artillery and matchlock guns, and founded the Mughal Empire. In his candid autobiography, the Baburnama, he found India a land of few charms, yet he admitted that it had masses of gold and silver and countless artisans and workmen of every sort.

(11.1) Name the autobiography written by Babur.

> The Baburnama.

(11.2) Whom did Babur defeat at the First Battle of Panipat?

> Ibrahim Lodi.

(11.3) What did Babur appreciate about India's economy? Explain with two points.

> (1) Great wealth — masses of gold and silver; (1) countless skilled artisans and workmen of every sort.

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In 1835, Thomas Macaulay wrote his Minute on Indian Education. Although he admitted he had no knowledge of Sanskrit or Arabic, he claimed that a single shelf of a good European library was worth the whole native literature of India and Arabia. His aim was to create a class of people 'Indian in blood and colour, but English in taste, in opinions, in morals, and in intellect'.

(12.1) In which year was Macaulay's Minute on Indian Education written?

> 1835.

(12.2) What kind of class of Indians did Macaulay want to create?

> Indian in blood and colour, but English in taste, opinions, morals and intellect.

(12.3) How did this policy affect traditional Indian education? Give two points.

> Any two (1 mark each): traditional schools (pathashalas, madrasas) slowly disappeared; English became the language of prestige; created a pool of cheap clerks; divided English-educated elites from the masses.

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In the 2024 general elections about 980 million Indians were eligible to vote, spread across 543 constituencies. Yet about 34 per cent of eligible voters did not cast their vote. Experts point to voter apathy, especially in cities, the growing influence of money, and the number of candidates with criminal records as challenges. They urge informed voters, awareness campaigns, and the participation of young people.

(13.1) How many Lok Sabha constituencies are there in India?

> 543.

(13.2) What percentage of eligible voters did not vote in 2024?

> About 34 per cent.

(13.3) Suggest any two ways of increasing voter participation.

> Any two (1 mark each): voter awareness campaigns through media and education; informing voters about candidates; encouraging youth participation; making voting easier (home/postal voting, facilities).

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5)

(I) Daulatabad
(II) Saraighat (Guwahati)
(III) Thanjavur
(IV) Jhansi
(V) Panna diamond mine
(VI) Zawar zinc mine

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Daulatabad located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Saraighat located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Thanjavur located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Jhansi located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Panna diamond mine located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Zawar zinc mine located? 1

1 mark for each correctly located and labelled place (any five); a position within about 150 km of the true location is acceptable. For Visually Impaired candidates: 1 mark for each correct state/UT (any five).

- (I) Daulatabad — **Maharashtra**
- (II) Saraighat (Guwahati) — **Assam**
- (III) Thanjavur — **Tamil Nadu**
- (IV) Jhansi — **Uttar Pradesh**
- (V) Panna diamond mine — **Madhya Pradesh**
- (VI) Zawar zinc mine — **Rajasthan**

